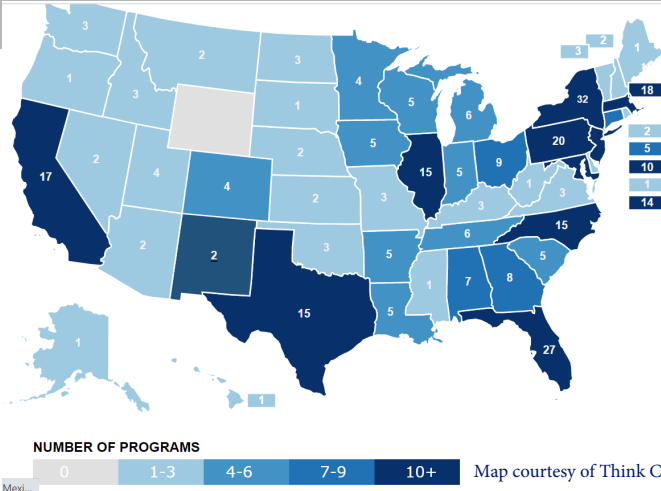




Postsecondary Education for Students with Intellectual Disability

What is Postsecondary Education for Students with Intellectual Disability?

There is a growing mix of college options for people with intellectual disability. There are 314 programs at community colleges, colleges, and universities across the country where students with intellectual disability are included with their non-disabled peers in postsecondary education. 141 of these are CTPs (Comprehensive Transition Program) or pending to become one.



What are Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disability (TPSID)?

TPSIDs are demonstration projects funded by the US Department of Education as authorized under the Higher Education Act. They provide high quality, inclusive postsecondary and transition programs for students with intellectual disability. InclusiveU was a TPSID recipient from 2015-2020.

Syracuse University's InclusiveU

InclusiveU offers a comprehensive college experience for students with intellectual and developmental disability which includes individualized and inclusive coursework, person-centered planning, professional internships, and social and extracurricular activities. Students can select University classes based on their interests and participate in on-campus internships to provide them with marketable, transferable job skills. Students have the opportunity to live in the residence halls and participate in graduation side by side with their peers.



How Do These Programs Make a Difference?

Proven Outcomes.

Individuals with intellectual disability (ID) have been historically excluded from full and equitable participation in many aspects of society: education, employment, community housing, government, and more. In college, students with ID obtain experiences similar to those of their non-disabled peers: community membership, emotional and social growth, intellectual stimulation, work experiences, career guidance, self-advocacy, and the development of problem solving and self-monitoring skills (Causton-Theoharis et. al., 2009; Grigal et al., 2013).



The current employment rate for people with IDD is 19%. If they have graduated from college, the rate increases to 65%.

How can you support and champion these programs?

The Higher Education Act created the TPSID model demonstration programs.

It's essential to continue supporting inclusive postsecondary education through the reauthorization of the Higher Education Act and expansion of Home and Community-based services.

